
Reflection

Big Tech Stocks

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Working on the Big Tech Stocks application pushed me to engage with several different layers of a real data project, from backend data handling to deployment to frontend design. Two things stood out the most along the way: the tool that helped me most, and the part of the process that surprised me.

Which MCP Helped Me the Most

The Fetch MCP was the tool that helped me the most. I used it to retrieve a real-world fact from Wikipedia about the history of the Apple I computer and embedded it directly into the application as an informational highlight for users. Learning to reliably fetch, parse, and display external web content inside a live Streamlit app taught me a lot about how backend data retrieval connects to what the user actually sees, and it made the application feel like a genuinely dynamic tool rather than a static exercise.

What Surprised Me

What surprised me most was how much of the difficulty came not from writing the app's core logic, but from deployment. I assumed that once the code worked locally, putting it live on Streamlit Cloud would be quick and simple. In reality, it took real attention to dependencies and configuration to make sure the app rendered correctly for someone opening it for the first time, not just on my own machine. It was a good reminder that a project isn't really finished until it works reliably outside your own environment.

Additional Challenges

Beyond deployment, I also worked on making the layout responsive so it would adapt well to different screen sizes, using Streamlit's wide layout setting and container-width scaling for the charts. Altogether, the project gave me a much better sense of how backend logic, external data, and frontend presentation need to work together for an application to feel complete.